Unit 6 — Mediation: A German Policy Text

Track E · Klasse 13 · Niveau E (Basisfach / Leistungsfach) · Abitur year

Learning objectives I

- *I can mediate a short German policy-style text into six to eight English sentences for a named addressee.*
- *I can preserve modal nuance, hedge structure, citation style, and disciplinary register simultaneously.*
- *I can choose reporting verbs that preserve the source's strength of claim and explain unfamiliar institutional terms.*

Lead-in I

Final mediation Unit. The source is a short fictional policy-style passage written for this exercise. Its sample size, findings and study period are invented; it is not a federal report or evidence about German education. Imagine an English-speaking comparative-education researcher as your addressee. The task is to convey only what this passage says, including its uncertainty and limits. Do not invent the contents of a longer report.

Reading I

Source — fictional policy-style passage

Der folgende fiktive Bericht untersucht die Entwicklung der Bildungsgerechtigkeit in Deutschland zwischen 2010 und 2025 und bezieht sich auf eine bundesweite Stichprobe von 1,2 Millionen Schülerinnen und Schülern. Methodisch nutzen wir mehrebenenanalytische Modelle. Die Ergebnisse legen nahe, dass die Korrelation zwischen sozio-ökonomischem Hintergrund und PISA-Ergebnis in den Stadtstaaten Berlin, Hamburg und Bremen leicht abgenommen hat, in den Flächenländern hingegen stabil geblieben ist. Bildungspolitische Implikationen diskutieren wir vorsichtig. Eine kausale Interpretation der Korrelationen ist auf Basis der vorliegenden Daten nicht möglich.

Reading II

Mediation conventions for policy texts
German-specific institutional terms: *Stadtstaaten* (German city-states — Berlin, Hamburg, Bremen), *Flächenländer* (German federal states other than the three city-states), *Bildungsgerechtigkeit* (educational equity / fairness), *Mehrebenen-analyse* (multilevel modelling).
Hedge preservation: *legen nahe → suggest*; *kausale Interpretation … nicht möglich → causal inference is not possible from the available data*.
Source references: preserve the source's reference to *PISA*. It contains no citation, link or NEPS finding; do not add one. Make the passage's fictional status clear in your introduction.

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. Match German term → English: *Stadtstaaten* → ?, *Flächenländer* → ?, *Bildungsgerechtigkeit* → ?, *Mehrebenenanalyse* → ?
2. Decide for the OECD addressee: keep + explain in brackets / paraphrase / drop entirely — *Stadtstaaten*, *PISA*, *Mehrebenenanalyse*.

Niveau E — productive

3. Build a 6-sentence English mediation of the source above.

Your turn I

Final mediation, six to eight sentences. Write for the comparative-education researcher. Identify the source as a fictional exercise, preserve the study period, sample, method, regional comparison and limit on causal inference. Explain an institutional term if the reader needs it. Choose reporting verbs for accuracy; there is no quota. Do not add claims about robustness, funding, data access, later research or other datasets.

Sample

Reflect I

- I can mediate a short fictional policy-style text in six to eight faithful English sentences.
- I can preserve hedges, the causal limitation and necessary institutional explanations.
- I can choose accurate reporting verbs without adding unsupported claims.

Further reading / listening I

- Goethe-Institut — Sprachmittlungs-Beispielaufgaben Oberstufe.
- OECD Education at a Glance — comparative-education register samples.